if your heart should ever slowly turn

Lee Sharks

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```

```
"then know / that I have loved you"—places love outside possession or response: the beloved's future recognitio
bearing, particularly the double-dash interruptions around "slowly, astonished," the unfolding image of leaves
}
```

Abstract

This record preserves the complete textual manifestation of Lee Sharks's five-line lyric *if your heart should ever slowly turn*. The poem imagines a beloved awakening slowly and astonished into a renewed world. Its final declaration—"then know / that I have loved you"—places love outside possession or response: the beloved's future recognition is enough to carry the speaker's past and continuing regard.

The text is the accessible and searchable counterpart to the image manifestation in #733. Punctuation and lineation are load-bearing, particularly the double-dash interruptions around "slowly, astonished," the unfolding image of leaves unbundling from rain, and the isolated movement into "then know." The authority description should preserve the poem's lowercase title and avoid converting the lyric into biographical evidence about any named relationship.

Body

if your heart should ever–slowly, astonished–turn

from sheltering slumber, leaves unbundling

from turned-away rain, and find the world made new:

then know

that I have loved you.

Suggested Citation

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